Chapter Twenty-Four

Industrialization Primary Cause for Environmental Crisis

Increasing Awareness of the Impact of Development on the Environment

Humans were, in general, not conscious of the adverse impact of their agricultural and industrial progress till about fifty to sixty years ago. This was because the tipping point in the use of nature's products and her capacity to absorb noxious gases, emissions and pollutants had not been reached. We enjoyed many free lunches. No more, however.

Humans have become far more aware of the adverse impacts of energy use, industrialization and excessive consumption. In the past fifty to sixty years, governments the world over have started controlling adverse environmental impact by regulating the use of fossil fuels, chemicals and certain materials. Industry has also invested in using materials and energy more efficiently and controlling emissions. The use of coal, the father of industrialization, is being reduced everywhere and the day is not far when its use becomes history.

Innovation of digitalization is enabling less use of materials and energy in production and distribution of goods and services. The use of several materials has peaked. Digitalization has introduced enormous efficiencies. Efficient industrialization and increasing universalization of digitalization will help humans bring the environment back to a sustainable state.